Tobias Treppmann

European user research for faith and digital products · German native · English C2

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PROFILE

I am a hands-on UX researcher and product design leader working inside European Christian digital products. My research has changed product strategy, reached difficult-to-access users and turned cultural insight into product decisions. I combine in-person and remote methods with Dovetail, UserTesting.com, Teams transcription and careful AI-assisted synthesis.

6 European markets

Church product work across Protestant and Catholic contexts

Research changed strategy

Shop-owner interviews challenged an executive assumption

Dovetail + Claude

Repository discipline with large-corpus qualitative synthesis

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (German Bible broadcaster and multi-platform consumer product) *Hamburg + Berlin, Germany*

- Lead product design and product-management work for Bible, streaming and connected-TV experiences. German users, local content and cultural fit shape the product direction.
- Run remote interviews recorded and transcribed in Microsoft Teams, then analyze them with Claude. For smaller studies I read responses directly to protect nuance and context.
- Use feature-level evidence to guide product priorities, including Bible use, AI-feature questions, streaming behavior, live TV, Light Mode and Sleep Timer usage.
- A concept survey reversed the redesign's initial dark-mode direction. Users described it as gloomy and asked for brightness and readability, so the product moved to a light-first system.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (church-management software across DE, DK, UK, SE, NO and CH) *Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin*

- Led product and design for software used by Protestant and Catholic churches across six European markets, working inside local language, organizational and church-data-protection differences.
- Validated a sensitive funeral-booking workflow with the German launch customer, pastors and funeral directors, after starting from the customer's own community research and synthesis.
- Turned those findings into a reusable platform capability: 70% less coordination time and 90% booking acceptance at the launch customer, then rollout across the customer base.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform across DACH, the UK and the US) *Berlin, Germany*

- Used Dovetail as the shared research repository and insight-sharing surface.
- Analyzed thousands of forum posts with Claude to identify sentiment, recurring pain points and feature requests at a scale the team could not have reviewed manually.
- Senior Leadership Team member; five direct reports across product design and UX writing, with four months also leading Product.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (enterprise analytics for regulated banks and insurers) *Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and New York*

- Secured executive-sponsored research access to analysts inside US banks and insurers and joined customer-site research to understand how they worked in regulated environments.
- Developed research protocols and iterative UserTesting.com screening that reached difficult-to-access analyst personas ordinary panels could not supply.
- Turned research into product direction, personas and roadmap input while leading the UX team across Germany and New York.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce platform for sellers and consumers) *Leipzig, Germany*

- In-person interviews with German shop owners challenged leadership's assumption that full automation was the right answer. The insight redirected the seller-platform strategy toward user control.
- Led and usability-tested a mobile T-shirt-designer research prototype. Strong user feedback moved the concept into production and helped shift the company's mobile direction.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck · service research and productization

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · coaching product designers across cultures

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, Pennsylvania, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, Pennsylvania, USA

Web Designer / Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, Pennsylvania, USA · international mission-driven nonprofit

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership
Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

Theological Studies
Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Qualitative research

In-depth interviews · usability testing · customer-site research · research protocols · participant screening · concept surveys · German-language research

Synthesis and research operations

Dovetail · UserTesting.com · Microsoft Teams transcription · Claude-assisted analysis · personas · opportunity framing · remote documentation

Cultural and product context

European Christian digital products · Bible, streaming, and connected-TV products · Protestant and Catholic church software · sensitive stakeholder research · translating insight into product decisions

Research reporting and collaboration

Producing research reports and insight summaries for global product teams · working synchronously and asynchronously across Europe and the US · research data, transcripts and media in Dovetail and Microsoft Teams

Tools and languages

Figma · Microsoft 365 · UserTesting.com · German native · English C2 · six years living and working in the US